JACOBY TRANSFERS

ABOUT THE DEALS

You may be either Opener or Responder, but you will always be in the South position.

Feel free to disagree with some of the bids that do not apply directly to Transfers. Deals 9 and 21 for example.

Although it is not included in the Deals you might wish to examine your and dummy's hand and make a Plan of how you would play the contract.

JACOBY TRANSFERS SUMMARY

Created by Oswald Jacoby a lot of years ago, there are two good reasons to use Transfers.

1. They provide a precise bidding method when the Responder to a 1NT opening has a 5 or 6 card Major suit.
2. They make the opening 1NT hand the declarer, keeping the stronger hand concealed.

Jacoby Transfers should only be used in conjunction with the Stayman Convention. The two work smoothly together with Stayman taking care of those hands where Responder has a 4-card Major(s) and Jacoby Transfers taking care of those hands where Responder has a 5- or 6-card Major.

The actual working of transfer bids is simple:
After a 1NT opening a 2♦ response requires Opener to bid 2♥, while a 2♥ response requires Opener to bid 2♠.
On his next bid Responder clarifies the picture by either placing the contract or by inviting Opener to do so.

Jacoby Transfers take much of the guesswork (sometimes called judgement) out of the bidding and steer you directly to these two goals:

1. With a partnership 26 points you will reach game, with 33 you will reach slam.
2. With a partnership 8+ cards in a Major suit you will play in that suit, otherwise you will play notrump.

For the first point consider this table which is based on the 1NT opener holding 15-17 points.

Resp Points	Opener Points			Bidding Target
	15	16	17	
8	23	24	25	Partscore
9	24	25	26	
10	25	26	27	
11	26	27	28	
12	27	28	29	Game
13	28	29	30	
14	29	30	31	
15	30	31	32	
16	31	32	33	
17	32	33	34	Slam
18	33	34	35	

Responder's actions are as follows:

- 8 points or fewer - either pass or transfer and then pass
- 9 points - invite partner to game
- 10 points - either invite or force to game, using your judgement
- 11-15 points - force to game
- 16 points - invite to slam
- 17 points - either invite or force to slam, using your judgement
- 18 points or more - force to slam

Opener's actions are as follows:

- 15 points - decline invitations
- 16 points - either decline or accept, using your judgement
- 17 points - accept invitations

As to the second point above (the 8-card trump fit) you must keep in mind that it is correct to open 1NT with 5-3-3-2 distribution, so it is possible for Opener to have a doubleton in the Major suit that Responder is interested in. Therefore Responder must bid differently with a 5-card suit than he does with a 6-card suit.

- With a 5-card Major Responder transfers Opener to that Major suit, then at his next turn bids notrump.
- With a 6-card Major Responder transfers Opener to that Major suit, then at his next turn rebids the suit.

Opener also has to keep on the right track when Responder has shown only 5 of the suit by rebidding notrump.

- With 2 cards in the transferred suit Opener stays with notrump.
- With 3+ cards in the transferred suit Opener returns to the Major suit.

Some comments are in order about the point count methods used on these pages.

- Initial point count for both hands is based on 4-3-2-1 plus one point for a fifth card in a suit.
- Revalued points (only after a trump fit is discovered) are +1 for a doubleton held by Opener.

- Responder must be very cautious about adding short-suit revalued points. As the long-trump hand Responder will not be able to gain a trick by ruffing since it usually uses a trump which would be a winner anyway.

25 examples will be worth more than another 1000 words.

Board: 1
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT
Declarer: North
Lead: ♣4

Board: 2
Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♥
Declarer: East
Lead: ♠3

Board: 3
Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: South
Lead: ♥7

Board: 4
Dealer: **West**

Contract: 6♥
Declarer: West
Lead: ♣2

Board: 5
Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠
Declarer: North
Lead: ♠2

Board 1
North Deals
None Vul

	♠ A 6 ♥ 9 6 5 ♦ K Q J 2 ♣ A K 9 8	
♠ K J 5 2 ♥ A 7 4 2 ♦ 10 9 7 6 ♣ J		♠ Q 4 ♥ J 8 3 ♦ 8 5 3 ♣ Q 6 5 4 2
	♠ 10 9 8 7 3 ♥ K Q 10 ♦ A 4 ♣ 10 7 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1NT	Pass	2♥
Pass	2♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♣4

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♥.

You say 2♠ and partner rebids 2NT.

Partner has 9 points and a 5-card ♠ suit. He is inviting you to choose a game if you have maximum.

Since you have 17 points you accept the invitation, but with only 2 ♠s you choose 3NT.

Board 2
East Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ J 10 7 6 ♥ A 4 2 ♦ 6 3 ♣ K Q 10 9	
♠ Q 9 8 5 4 ♥ K Q 10 8 3 ♦ 7 5 ♣ 3		♠ A K ♥ J 6 5 ♦ A K J 4 ♣ J 8 6 5
	♠ 3 2 ♥ 9 7 ♦ Q 10 9 8 2 ♣ A 7 4 2	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1NT	Pass
2♦	Pass	2♥	Pass
2♠	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			

4♥ by East
Lead: ♠3

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♦.

You obey partner and bid 2♥ but he then bids 2♠.

Partner has told you that he has an inviting, 9-point hand with 5 of each Major. He wants you to choose a Major and also decide whether to play game or partscore.

Despite your ♠s being so beautiful there are only two of them so you pick ♥s. And since you have a maximum 17 points you bid the game, 4♥.

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul

	♠ A K 8 7 3 ♥ K 10 9 6 5 ♦ 7 5 ♣ 9	
♠ J 6 4 ♥ 7 2 ♦ Q 9 8 3 2 ♣ A Q 7		♠ 9 2 ♥ J 8 3 ♦ A 10 6 ♣ 10 8 4 3 2
	♠ Q 10 5 ♥ A Q 4 ♦ K J 4 ♣ K J 6 5	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	2♥	Pass	2♠
Pass	3♥	Pass	4♠
All Pass			

4♠ by South
Lead: ♥7

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♥.

You say 2♠. Partner then bids 3♥.

Partner has a game forcing hand and is 5-5 in the Majors. He has asked you to choose one of them to bid game in.

With 3 of each you might be inclined to choose your stronger one, ♥s, but in fact that doesn't really matter since partner is probably stronger in ♠s.

What does matter is those minor suits. If the opening lead is a ♣ or ♦, which is very likely, you want the lead to be coming into your hand, not partner's. And in general you would prefer to have the stronger hand remain concealed. So you bid 4♠ where you will be declarer, rather than 4♥ where partner would be declarer.

Board 4
West Deals
Both Vul

	♠ J 7 6 2 ♥ 8 ♦ 6 5 2 ♣ 7 5 4 3 2	
♠ 10 5 ♥ K Q 10 4 ♦ A K 7 ♣ K Q 9 8		♠ K Q 9 4 ♥ A J 9 7 3 ♦ 8 3 ♣ A 6
	♠ A 8 3 ♥ 6 5 2 ♦ Q J 10 9 4 ♣ J 10	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
1NT	Pass	2♦	Pass
3♥	Pass	4♣	Pass
4♦	Pass	6♥	
All Pass			

6♥ by West
Lead: ♣2

You open 1NT and partner responds 2♦.

Just hold it a minute and DO NOT say 2♥. True, when partner transfers, you **almost** always just obey and complete the transfer. This is the one time when you don't. You had a 17 point 1NT opener with 4 ♥s and a doubleton. As soon as partner told you to bid ♥s your hand became worth 18 points because of the good trump support and the doubleton. So you inform partner of this by making the "super-accept" bid of 3♥. In other words, you complete the transfer with a jump.

Partner's eyes get big (but you aren't allowed to notice that) and he bids 4♣.

Partner's ♣ bid was not a suit, you already have an agreed suit, ♥s. The ♣ bid was showing you first round control in ♣s, and is a slam try by partner.

You continue the search for slam by showing your first round ♦ control, you bid 4♦.

That was all partner needed to hear, he jumps straight to 6♥.

Board 5
North Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ J 10 4 ♥ A K ♦ A K 9 7 ♣ K Q 9 8	
♠ A K 7 ♥ J 9 8 6 4 ♦ 10 ♣ J 7 5 2		♠ 6 2 ♥ Q 10 5 3 ♦ Q J 5 3 ♣ 10 6 4
	♠ Q 9 8 5 3 ♥ 7 2 ♦ 8 6 4 2 ♣ A 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	2NT	Pass	3♥
Pass	3♠	Pass	3NT
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			

4♠ by North
Lead: ♠2

You open 2NT and partner responds 3♥.

You bid 3♠, just as partner asked. He puts you in game at 3NT. Bid or pass?

Bid of course. You have an 8-card ♠ fit so you prefer ♠s to notrump.

As you can see, 3NT would surely go down with a ♥ lead, while 4♠ is cold.

One hand doesn't mean it will always be like this, but usually if you have an 8-card fit the Major suit game will be better than 3NT.